# Console command

Русский · User guide · Operations · Wrappers · AI agent

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`media_cli.cmd` in the root of the program runs what the buttons of the window run: an operation, with the same fields and the same presets. The window is the face of this command: whatever it starts, it starts through the command, and the first line of every run in its journal is a ready command that can be repeated in a console.

The command is for the cases where an operation is started not by a person at the window: a batch file, another tool, an AI agent, a long night of encodes.

## Commands

| Command | What it does |
|---|---|
| `describe` | The operations, their fields with choices and defaults, the presets and the layout of the window - one line of JSON. |
| `run` | Run an operation. |
| `wrapper NAME` | Run a wrapper of `Scripts\` by its name: `media_cli.cmd wrapper ff-x264-crf14`. |

| Command | What it does |
| --- | --- |
| `map` | The map of the program from its data: sections, operations, fields, presets, wrappers, the texts in both languages. `--out FILE` writes it to a file; `--docs` writes the reference documents (`OPERATIONS_*`, `SCRIPTS_*` and the tables of this guide). |
| `components` | The versions of yt-dlp, Deno, mpv, FFmpeg, 7-Zip and the GPU driver; `--latest` adds the newest releases (asked of GitHub at most once a day). |
| `plan --operation install_ffmpeg` | What an installer would download: the files, their source and size. Nothing is downloaded. |
| `version` | The version of the program. |

`--root FOLDER` before the command names another copy of the program; `--language ru` or `en` - the language of the journal (the language of the window when not named).

## Running an operation

```
.\media_cli.cmd run --operation storage_run
.\media_cli.cmd run --operation editing_run --set editing_profile=prores_lt_mov
.\media_cli.cmd run --operation storage_run --set storage_profile=hevc10_crf14 --set
encode_backend=cuda `
    --source "D:\Footage\Day 1" --target "D:\Encoded" --result
D:\Encoded\outcome.json
.\media_cli.cmd run --operation youtube_run --set
"youtube_url=https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=..."
```

| Key | Purpose |
| --- | --- |
| `--operation ID` | The id of the operation. The table below gives the id of every mode of the window; `describe` gives all of them. |
| `--set NAME=VALUE` | The value of one field; may be repeated. A flag is `true` or `false`, a row of ticks - its values separated by commas (`--set target_codecs=x264,hevc_x265`). A preset field (`storage_profile`, `editing_profile` ...) sets the fields it names when it is named, and the other `--set` are laid over it; left unnamed, every field keeps its own default - the preset a form shows first is not applied by itself. |

| Key | Purpose |
|---|---|
| `--params FILE` | A JSON file "field: value". `--set` is laid over it. |
| `--source PATH` | A folder (its subfolders too) or one file. Without the key - `input` of the program. |
| `--target PATH` | A folder. Without the key - `output` of the program. |
| `--only KINDS` | The kinds of file to take from the Source: `mkv` or `mov,mxf`. |
| `--result FILE` | Where to write the outcome: a `.json` file outside the Source and outside `config\`. A full path, or call the command from the program folder. |
| `--cancel-file FILE` | The stop file: when it appears, FFmpeg is ended and a half-written file is taken away. |
| `--dry-run` | Run nothing: say the FFmpeg or yt-dlp commands the operation would start. An operation that cannot only say them is refused. |

The names of the fields and their choices are those of `describe` and of the list of operations. A field that is not set goes with its default - as in a form of the window just opened. A relative `--source` or `--target` is counted from the folder of the program; a relative `--result`, `--params` or `--cancel-file` - from the folder the command is called from.

## What each mode of the window is

| Section | Mode | Call |
|---|---|---|
| AUDIO | EXTRACT | `media_cli.cmd run --operation audio_run --set audio_workflow=extract` |
| AUDIO | SOUND IN VIDEO | `media_cli.cmd run --operation audio_run --set audio_workflow=in_video` |
| AUDIO | CONVERT | `media_cli.cmd run --operation audio_run --set audio_workflow=audio_files` |
| ENCODE | ARCHIVE | `media_cli.cmd run --operation archive_run` |

| Section | Mode | Call |
| --- | --- | --- |
| ENCODE | EDITING | `media_cli.cmd run --operation editing_run` |
| ENCODE | STORAGE | `media_cli.cmd run --operation storage_run` |
| ENCODE | DELIVERY | `media_cli.cmd run --operation delivery_run` |
| PACKAGE | VIDEO | `media_cli.cmd run --operation remux_run --set remux_stream_mode=video` |
| PACKAGE | AUDIO | `media_cli.cmd run --operation remux_run --set remux_stream_mode=audio` |
| PACKAGE | VIDEO AND AUDIO | `media_cli.cmd run --operation remux_run --set remux_stream_mode=video_audio` |
| PACKAGE | SUBTITLES | `media_cli.cmd run --operation subtitles_extract` |
| CUT | KEEP | `media_cli.cmd run --operation trim_run --set trim_action=keep` |
| CUT | CUT OUT | `media_cli.cmd run --operation trim_run --set trim_action=cut` |
| CUT | SPLIT | `media_cli.cmd run --operation trim_run --set trim_action=split` |
| FRAME RATE | VARISPEED | `media_cli.cmd run --operation fps_run --set fps_mode=varispeed` |
| FRAME RATE | CONFORM | `media_cli.cmd run --operation fps_run --set fps_mode=conform` |
| COLOR | LUT | `media_cli.cmd run --operation grading_run` |
| DOWNLOAD | BEST MP4 | `media_cli.cmd run --operation youtube_run --set youtube_profile=best_mp4` |
| DOWNLOAD | SAFE MP4 | `media_cli.cmd run --operation youtube_run --set youtube_profile=safe_mp4` |
| DOWNLOAD | OWN VIDEO | `media_cli.cmd run --operation youtube_run --set youtube_profile=video_custom` |
| DOWNLOAD | FOR UPLOAD | `media_cli.cmd run --operation youtube_run --set youtube_profile=upload_ready` |

| Section | Mode | Call |
| --- | --- | --- |
| DOWNLOAD | OWN AUDIO | `media_cli.cmd run --operation youtube_run --set youtube_profile=audio_custom` |
| DOWNLOAD | SUBTITLES | `media_cli.cmd run --operation youtube_run --set youtube_profile=subs_only` |

SOURCE INFO, SERVICE and the buttons beside a field:

| Operation | What it is |
| --- | --- |
| `probe_source` | Probe Source: Run ffprobe once for Source, print a compact table and update the media status line. |
| `source_info` | Source Info: Run ffprobe for Source and print every audio stream: codec, sample format, sample rate, bit depth, channels, bitrate and tags. |
| `inventory` | Inventory: Count project folders. |
| `selftest` | Selftest: Check ffmpeg, ffprobe, yt-dlp and Deno. |
| `profile_doctor` | Profile Doctor: Validate GUI operations, script wrappers and the shared preset catalog. |
| `hardware_capabilities` | Hardware capabilities: Run short FFmpeg smoke tests for CPU, QSV/NVENC/AMF H.264 and HEVC, SVT-AV1 and dav1d. |
| `preset_test_matrix` | Preset Test Matrix: Run portable 1-second smoke tests across audio, remux, FPS, LUT, archive, editing, storage and delivery presets. |
| `install_7zip` | Install 7-Zip: Install or refresh portable 7-Zip; required before FFmpeg 7z payloads. |
| `install_ffmpeg` | Install FFmpeg: Install or refresh portable FFmpeg Gyan GPL payload into Tools/ffmpeg. |
| `install_ytdlp` | Install yt-dlp: Install or refresh portable yt-dlp and Deno into Tools. |
| `install_mpv` | Install mpv: Install or refresh portable mpv into Tools/mpv: the player of the trim. |
| `youtube_formats` | Formats of the link: What formats the link offers - resolution, codecs, size - listed in the journal, nothing downloaded. One of them is taken with the profile Own video. |

| Operation | What it is |
| --- | --- |
| `youtube_cookies_import` | Take under DPAPI: The cookies file of the field Cookies file sealed with DPAPI for this account of Windows into config\cookies.dpapi: downloads with Cookies - File take this copy, and the open file is no longer needed. |

## The output

The lines of the operation's journal, as in the window: `[OK]`, `[WARN]`, `[ERR]`, `[CMD]` - the command FFmpeg was started with, `[PREFLIGHT]` - the checks before the run, `[PROGRESS] clip.mp4 -> x264 [#####---] 42% 00:01:12/00:02:50 speed=3.4x` with FFmpeg's own line `frame= … fps= … time= … speed=` under it, and FFmpeg's last word `Lsize=` at the end. The same lines go to the journal file in `logs\`, and the report of the run - to `report\`.

A program that reads the output by a pipe also gets service lines: `::media::{"started": …}`, `{"progress": 0.42}`, `{"activity": …}`, `{"finished": {"outcome": …}}`. A console does not show them.

## Outcome and exit codes

| Code | Outcome | What it means |
| --- | --- | --- |
| 0 | `done` | The operation finished. |
| 1 | `failed` | It ran and something broke, or a file failed or was refused: the journal says what. |
| 2 | - / `refused` | A wrong call - a field the operation has not, a value that is none of its choices, `--dry-run` of an operation that cannot only say its commands; or the checks before the run refused it - no file of its kind in the Source, no FFmpeg. Nothing was run. |
| 130 | `stopped` | Stopped by the stop file (`--cancel-file`), before the first file or during one. |

The file of `--result`:

```
{
 "operation": "storage_run",
 "outcome": "done",
 "ok": true,
 "message": "Operation finished.",
 "data": {
  "processed": 1,
  "files": 1,
  "log_file": "...\\logs\\2026-10-15 22-34-54-804_storage_run.log",
  "batch_report_md": "...\\report\\2026-10-15 22-34-54-
804_storage_run\\batch_report.md"
 },
 "parameters": { "storage_profile": "x264_crf14", "target_codecs": ["x264"], "crf":
14, "...": "..." },
 "source": "D:\\Footage\\Day 1",
 "target": "D:\\Encoded",
 "seconds": 2.1
}
```


`parameters` are all the values the operation ran with, the defaults included: the run can be repeated from them exactly. `data` is what the operation tells: a media operation `processed` (files written), `skipped` (passed by, the reason in the journal), `files` (files of the Source), `failed` where it goes on past a failed file and `refused` where it turned a file down; a download `processed`, `downloaded` - the paths of what it wrote - and `existing`, found there already.

## Where the result goes

Into a folder of the operation in the Target, and inside it a folder of the settings - named by the target and its values, not by the preset: `Storage\x264_crf14_slow\clip.mp4`, `Editing\prores422\clip.mov`, `Archive\…`, `Delivery\…`, `Audio\…`, `Remux\…`, `Trim\…`, `FPS\…`, `Color\…`, `Subtitles\…`; the subfolders of the Source are kept below it. `--dry-run` prints the exact path. Downloads go to `Download\<uploader>\<date> - <title> [<id>].<ext>` (a playlist: `Download\<number> - <title> [<id>].<ext>`).

A file already there is not written over unless `--set overwrite=true`: the journal says `[SKIP] NAME already exists and Overwrite is off`, FFmpeg is not started for it, and the outcome counts it in `skipped`, not in `processed`.

## Wrappers

95 files of `Scripts\` - `ff-*`, `audio-*`, `yt-*` - each a ready task with its values, called by a double click, from a console or by name through the command: `media_cli.cmd wrapper ff-prores-lt-mov`. Each is listed with the same call through `run` in the list of wrappers. The wrappers of a trim take the file and the points from the variables `AUDION_TRIM_FILE`, `AUDION_TRIM_START`, `AUDION_TRIM_END`; the downloads - the links after the name, or `input\urls.txt`.

The menus `launcher_project.cmd`, `launcher_tools.cmd` and `cli\launcher-*.cmd` find a wrapper by typing (FZF).

## Clearing the folders

The operations that clear the Source, the Target or the working folder delete for good and are not run from the command: the window clears them through the Recycle Bin.